

DILEEP KUMAR CMA,CSCA

Director FP&A | Head of Finance – Real Estate, Destinations, Giga Projects & Government Entities

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Summary

Director-level FP&A and finance leader with over 18 years of experience across giga events, real estate-led destinations, and government-backed developments in the GCC. Played a key finance leadership role in the transformation of Expo 2020 Dubai into Expo City Dubai, supporting enterprise budgeting, P&L ownership, leasing economics, and CapEx/OpEx governance within complex, multi-stakeholder environments.

Trusted advisor to CEOs and Boards, delivering strategic financial insights, scenario analysis, and disciplined execution to support long-term value creation. Certified CMA and CSCA professional with strong foundations in audit, internal controls, ERP-enabled finance transformation, and analytics-driven performance management.

Experience

- **EXPO CITY DUBAI**

Dubai

10/2022 - Present

FP&A Manager-CMO Office
 - Led senior FP&A role during the transformation of Expo 2020 Dubai into Expo City Dubai, overseeing enterprise FP&A across Events & Experience, Education & Culture, Expo Dubai Group, and Expo Dubai Foundation.
 - Managed annual budgeting and rolling forecasts for an **AED ~550M portfolio**, ensuring disciplined resource allocation across operations, cultural programming, and destination initiatives.
 - Partnered with senior leadership post-Expo to support financial planning for destination activation, footfall, events, and asset utilisation within a mixed-use real estate environment.
 - Prepared comprehensive CEO and Board financial packs, including **management discussion & analysis (MD&A)**, variance insights, and scenario planning to support sustainable economic decision-making.
 - Developed enterprise FP&A dashboards, P&L reports, and KPI frameworks using Power BI and Microsoft Dynamics 365, reducing reporting cycles by ~40% and enabling earlier executive interventions.
 - Improved forecasting accuracy by ~12% year-on-year through enhanced financial modelling, seasonality analysis, and structured variance reviews.
 - Directed CapEx/OpEx governance, improving financial discipline, audit readiness, compliance, and accountability in regulated settings.
- **EXPO CITY DUBAI / EXPO 2020 DUBAI**

Expo 2020 dubai

09/2021 - 09/2022

Commercial Finance Manager – Real Estate, Retail & Destination Operations
 - Finance leadership role spanning the giga-event operations of Expo 2020 Dubai and the initial transition into Expo City Dubai.
 - Led commercial finance and P&L reporting for 100+ F&B and retail operators during Expo 2020, operating within a high-intensity, multi-stakeholder giga-event environment.
 - Consolidated operator-level P&Ls and analysed revenue/costs. Delivered insights for leasing, pricing, margins, and operations.
 - Owned end-to-end commercial finance activities, including preparation of SOFA (Statements of Financial Accounts), operator settlements, reconciliations, and financial contract closure post-event.
 - Partnered closely with commercial, legal, real estate, and operations teams to ensure contractual compliance, accurate settlements, and timely closure of operator accounts.
 - Supported the transition of retail and F&B commercial finance frameworks from event-based operations to steady-state destination models, including reporting cadence, controls, and performance metrics.
- **TABLEZ FOOD COMPANY**

Abu Dhabi

09/2016 - 08/2021

Finance Manager – Cost & Operations (Multi-Outlet, UAE & India)
 - Directed finance, cost control, and performance management across 36 F&B outlets spanning GCC and India, covering budgeting, forecasting, pricing, margin analysis, inventory control, and operational reporting.
 - Led outlet-level and regional P&L reviews, providing senior leadership with profitability insights and performance improvement recommendations.
 - Implemented analytics-driven flash cost and variance reporting, reducing wastage and purchase variances by ~3% and improving commercial visibility.
 - Played a key role in Microsoft Dynamics AX ERP rollout across five countries, supporting scalable finance operations, standardised controls, and improved data integrity.
 - Partnered with operations, procurement, and culinary teams as a finance business partner, embedding financial discipline and accountability.
 - Built, mentored, and developed finance and cost control teams, strengthening governance culture and management reporting capability.

Experience



LAGARDÈRE TRAVEL RETAIL

Abu Dhabi

Head of Cost Controls (Airport Retail & F&B)

10/2014 - 08/2016

- Led operational finance and cost control across airport retail and F&B assets, embedding SAP-driven controls, standardised reporting, and governance frameworks.
- Delivered cost optimisation initiatives resulting in ~3% food cost reduction and supported ~15% revenue improvement through pricing and process enhancements.
- Built and led regional cost control teams, improving compliance, reporting discipline, and operational finance maturity.



SFC GROUP

Abu Dhabi

Manager - Internal Audit & Cost Controls Progressed from Accounts Officer

11/2005 - 09/2014

- Progressed through multiple roles to lead divisional finance for central kitchen operations and 20+ F&B outlets across the GCC, establishing full-spectrum finance ownership.
- Led budgeting, forecasting, and performance reporting, providing management with foresight on costs, margins, and risks, while enhancing financial decision-making.
- Owned working capital and cash discipline, optimizing inventory turns, procurement controls, payables management, and outlet-level cash controls.
- Established and enforced internal control frameworks and audit processes, acting as primary finance owner during audits and compliance reviews.
- Acted as a finance business partner to operations and senior management, translating financial data into actionable operational decisions.



HAMID HUSSAIN & CO

Kerala

Assistant Auditor

01/2004 - 10/2005

- Supported statutory and internal audits across cash, AP/AR, and internal control environments for multi-industry clients.
- Building strong foundations in accounting standards, compliance, and audit discipline.

Certifications

- Certified Management Accountant (CMA – USA)
- Certified in Strategy & Competitive Analysis (CSCA – IMA, USA)
- IMA Certificate in Data Analytics & Visualization
- Google Prompting Essentials -Google Certified
- Diploma in IFRS (ACCA) – In Progress

Education

University of Calicut

India

Master of Commerce - M.Com

University of Calicut

India

Bachelor of Commerce - B.Com

Languages

English Proficient ●●●●●

Arabic Advanced ●●●●●

Hindi Native ●●●●●

Malayalam Native ●●●●●

Skills

Enterprise FP&A & Budgeting · P&L Ownership · Performance Management · CapEx / OpEx Governance · Commercial Management · Stakeholder Management · Forecasting · Scenario Planning · Executive & Board Reporting · Financial Modelling · Variance Analysis · ERP Enablement · BI Enablement · Microsoft Dynamics 365 · Power BI